A-A-001446C
January 19, 1990
INTERIM REVISION OF
A-A-1446B
May 1, 1983

# INTERIM COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

## ENVELOPE, MAILING

This interim Commercial Item Description was developed by the General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Division, New York, NY 10278 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal Agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for change to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this interim commercial item description as a valid exception to A-A-1446B and in preference to Federal Specification UU-E-522.

Classification.
Envelopes shall conform with the applicable style as specified (see 6.A)

Style A - Bleached Kraft (see 1.J)
Style B - Natural Kraft (see 1.J)
Style C - White Wove (see 1.K)
Style D - Color Wove (see 1.K)

1. Salient characteristics:

A. Construction. Envelopes shall be high-cut diagonal, web-fed point flap, side seam or center seam construction, at the option of the supplier, unless specified (see 6.I). Envelopes shall be sufficiently high cut so as to prevent the flap adhesive from contacting the envelope contents. The sealed seams shall not adhere to the inside of the envelope. Envelopes shall be free from cuts, folds, tears, machine marks, foreign matter, dirt, ink smears and adhesive stains.

When specified (see 6.C), for use in specific automatic inserting and sealing machines, the envelopes shall meet the design and construction requirements specified by the equipment manufacturer.

FSC 7530

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B. Flap adhesive. All sealing flap adhesive shall be the water-activated type of such a consistency to prevent premature sealing of the flap and curling of the envelope after drying.

(1) The flap adhesive shall be uniformly applied and have a minimum thickness of 0.0006 inch. The flaps shall be capable of being quickly and securely sealed using finger tips after moistening the adhesive. When opened 15 to 20 seconds after sealing, the flap shall pull fibers from the body of the envelope from not less than 75% of the adhesive area. The flap adhesive must cover at least 60% of the area of the flap beyond the throat.

(2) Size of flap. Unless specified in the contract/order (see 6.D), the minimum flap size shall be as follows:

(a) For envelopes less than 6-1/8 " x 11-1/2" sealing flap must exceed the throat by at least 3/4" or what the contractor does commercially whichever is larger.

(b) For envelopes equal to or larger than 6-1/8" x 11-1/2" the sealing flap must exceed the throat by at least 1-1/2" or what the contractor does commercially whichever is larger, (exception is if the automated inserting and sealing machine requires a smaller flap).

C. Split gumming. Split gumming is permitted on high-cut diagonal seams but shall be positioned over the seams and not exceed seam width.

D. Resin gumming. When specified (see 6.E), resin gum (temperature and humidity resistant) shall be supplied on the sealing flap. Resin gummed envelopes may have split gumming on the sealing flap. On resin gummed envelopes without split gumming, there shall be no contact between the sealing flap and the diagonal seams except the very tip of the flap. Envelopes with resin gum shall be able to withstand test storage conditions of $100^{\circ} \pm 2^{\circ}$ F and 80 $\pm$ 2 percent relative humidity for 24 hours without blocking.

E. All adhesive. All adhesive shall be clean and free from offensive odor and ingredients that would discolor the paper.

F. Windows. Windows, when specified (see 6.F), shall have rounded or slightly rounded corners shall be the size and location specified and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service regulations. The window shall be covered on the inside with a transparent polystyrene window material glued securely on all edges so as not to interfere with insertion or contents. The transparent polystyrene window material shall be free of conditions which would prevent the address from being distinctly legible.



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G. Printing. Printing shall be as specified (see 6.G) and shall comply with all applicable U.S. Postal Service and GSA Information Resources Service regulations. The envelopes shall accept printing and ink writing without feathering, smearing, or penetrating to the reverse side.

H. Physical properties. Envelopes shall be supplied in one of four styles (see 1.J & 1.K). Natural kraft envelopes shall be made from commercial envelope grade natural kraft with surface sizing.

I. Tolerances. A tolerance of ± 1/8 inch shall be allowed on the dimensions of high cut diagonal envelopes; a tolerance of ± 1/16 inch shall be allowed on the dimensions of web fed envelopes. The placement of windows is included in these dimensional tolerances. The dimensional tolerances of the window itself is ± 1/64 inch.

J. Styles A and B requirements.

Style A - Bleached Kraft, White or light brown as specified (see 6.J) 100 percent sulfate pulp.
Style B - Natural kraft, 100 percent sulfate pulp.

Required basis weight below shall be as specfied in contract/order (see 6.K)

| | | | | | | TAPPI # |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Basis wt.(17 x 22-500), ± 5 percent pounds | 20 | 24 | 28 | 32 | 40 | T-410 |
| Bursting strength, min. : $lbs/in^2$ | 30 | 38 | 44 | 50 | 60 | T-403 |
| Thickness, SUB 20 only : inch | 0.0040 - 0.0051 | | | | | T-411 |
| Smoothness, Sheffield, (Style B only) | average 65 min./275 max. | | | | | T-518 |

K. Styles C and D requirements.

Style C - White, 95 percent bleached chemical pulp; unbleached, and/or groundwood not to exceed 5 percent.
Style D - Colored, 100 percent bleached chemical pulp; pulp dyed goldenrod, blue, green or pink, as specified (see 6.L).

Required basis weight below shall be as specfied in contract/order (see 6.K)

| | | | TAPPI # |
|---|---|---|---|
| Basis wt (17 x 22-500), ± 5 percent: pounds | 20 | 24 | T-410 |
| Bursting strength, min. : $lbs/in^2$ | 20 | 24 | T-403 |
| Opacity, average, min. : percent | 86 | 89 | UM-411 |
| No individual opacity measurement less than: % | 84 | 87 | |



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ange between maximum and minimum acceptable DYNAMIC RANGE FOR

2. Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this commercial item description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirement.

Inspection levels and acceptable quality shall be in accordance with Mil Std. 105 as shown in Table I, unless stated otherwise.

Table I

| Examine | Inspection Levels | AQLs(% defective) |
|---|---|---|
| Visual Defects | I | 6.5 |
| Examination for Dimensions | S-2 | 2.5 |
| Preparation for Delivery | S-2 | 2.5 |
| Count | S-2 | 2.5 |

TAPPI TESTS (see 1.J & 1.K for individual TAPPI's which provide specific sampling instructions).

3. Regulatory requirements. The contractor shall certify that the product offered shall include a minimum of 50% waste paper for Styles A, B, and C; for Style D it shall be 50% recovered material. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

A. "Waste paper" means any of the following materials:

(1) Postconsumer materials such as:
(a) Paper, paperboard, and fibrous wastes from retail stores, office buildings, homes, and so forth, after they have passed through their end usage as a consumer item, including: Used corrugated boxes, old newspapers, old magazines, mixed waste paper, tabulating cards, and used cordage, and

(b) All paper, paperboard, and fibrous wastes that enter and are collected from municipal solid waste; and



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(2) Manufacturing, forest residues, and other wastes such as:

(a) Dry paper and paperboard waste generated after completion of the paper making process (that is, those manufacturing operations up to and including the cutting and trimming of the paper machine reel into smaller rolls or rough sheets) including: Envelope cuttings, bindery trimmings, and other paper and paperboard waste, resulting form printing, cutting, forming, and other converting operations; bag, box, and carton manufacturing wastes; and butt rolls, mill wrappers, and rejected unused stock; and;

(b) Finished paper and paperboard from obsolete inventories of paper and paperboard manufacturers, merchants, wholesalers, dealers, printers, converters, or others;

B. "Recovered materials" means waste material and by products that have been recovered or diverted from solid waste, but such term does not include those materials and by-products generated from, and commonly reused within, an original manufacturing process. In the case of paper and paper products, the term "recovered materials" includes:

(1) Postconsumer materials such as:
(a) Paper, paperboard, and fibrous wastes from retail stores, office buildings, homes, and so forth, after they have passed through their end usage as a consumer item, including: Used corrugated boxes, old newspapers, old magazines, mixed waste paper, tabulating cards, and used cordage, and,
(b) All paper, paperboard, and fibrous wastes that enter and are collected from municipal solid waste; and

(2) Manufacturing, forest residues, and other wastes such as:
(a) Dry paper and paperboard waste generated after completion of the paper making process (that is, those manufacturing operations up to and including the cutting and trimming of the paper machine reel into smaller rolls or rough sheets) including envelope cuttings, bindery trimmings, and other paper and paperboard waste, resulting from printing, cutting, forming, and other converting operations; bag, box and carton manufacturing wastes; and butt rolls, mill wrappers, and rejected unused stock; and
(b) Finished paper and paperboard from obsolete inventories of paper and paperboard manufacturers, merchants, wholesalers, dealers, printers, converters, or others;



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(c) Fibrous by-products of harvesting, manufacturing, extractive, or woodcutting processes, flax, straw, linters, bagasse, slash, and other forest residues;
(d) Wastes generated by the conversion of goods made from fibrous material (e.g., waste rope from cordage manufacture, textile mill waste, and cuttings); and
(e) Fibers recovered from waste water that otherwise would enter the waste stream.

4. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5. Referenced Documents

A. GSA Information Resources Management Services Regulations are available from the Commissioner, Information Resources Management Services, Washington, DC 20405.

B. Postal regulations are available from the United States Postal Service, Rates and Classification Department, 475 L'Enfant Plaza, S.W., Washington, DC 20260-5300.

C. TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

6. Ordering Data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents. If orders are placed against an existing contract then only those factors that the contract allows may be shown on an order.

A. Style of envelope paper (see 1J & 1K).
B. Size of envelope.
C. If intended for automatic inserting and sealing machine, identify make and model (See 1A).
D. If sealing flap size shall be other than specified (see 1.B.(2)).
E. If resin gumming is required (see 1.D).
F. Windows, if required (see 1.F).
G. Printing, if required (see 1.G).
H. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking required (See 4).
I. Specific Construction, if required (see 1.A).
J. Specific Color of bleached kraft stock (see 1.J).
K. Specific basis weight.(see 1.J & 1K).
L. Style D Specify color (see 1.K).



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